There are thousands of built-in functions in PHP. PHP functions are similar to other programming languages. A function is a piece of code which takes one more input in the form of parameter and does some processing and returns a value.

In addition to the built-in functions, PHP also allows you to define your own functions. It is a way to create reusable code packages that perform specific tasks and can be kept and maintained separately form main program.

PHP supports the concept of variable functions. This means that if a variable name has parentheses appended to it, PHP will look for a function with the same name as whatever the variable evaluates to, and will attempt to execute it. Among other things, this can be used to implement callbacks, function tables, and so forth.

Variable functions will not work with language constructs such as echo, print, unset(), isset(), empty(), include, require and the like. Utilize wrapper functions to make use of any of these constructs as variable functions

3.1 FUNCTIONS IN PHP

A function is a piece of code in a larger program. The function performs a specific task. The advantages of using functions are:

- Reducing duplication of code
- Decomposing complex problems into simpler pieces
- Improving clarity of the code
- Reuse of code
- Information hiding

There are two basic types of functions. Built-in functions and user defined ones. The built-in functions are part of the PHP language. Examples are: phpinfo(), round() or abs(). The user defined functions are created by application programmers to cover their needs. They are created with the function keyword.

3.1.1 PHP defining functions

A function is created with the function keyword.

simple.php

```
<?php

function displayVersion() {

    echo “this is PHP “ . phpversion();
```